

Full Review to Production in a Day

July 7, 2026 · branch **main** · commits bbabd47 → 742de4d · pushed & deployed to Vercel

29

COMMITTS

+2.0k

LINES ADDED

46

FILES CHANGED

24→35PLANTS IN
DATASET**10**

BUGS FIXED

What happened

Three parallel reviewers swept the codebase with different lenses: correctness, Next.js/SEO/accessibility, and portfolio presentation. Every finding was implemented the same day as five stacked branches with one commit per numbered item, then a sixth request added a visual showpiece pass on the Bed Designer. Each commit passed TypeScript and ESLint; each branch passed a full production build; visual work was screenshot-verified in a real browser; dataset changes were checked by invariant scripts (companion symmetry, archetype coverage, note coverage). The stack merged to main as a clean fast-forward and went live the same evening.

Shipped, by area

Data & correctness

- **Fixed:** Hawaii / Puerto Rico / Guam ZIPs (zones 12-13) always saw the "no crop matches" empty state; tropical zones now share the zone-11 crop list
- **Fixed:** zone lookup blocked up to 1.2s on the network despite an instant offline answer; the fallback now renders immediately and the API refines in the background
- **Fixed:** the water-wise collection's 11 plants (okra, tepary bean, amaranth, sunflower, melon, sweet potato, and 5 herbs) existed in the archetype map and icon set but never in the dataset; restored with symmetric companion links
- **Fixed:** planting-calendar months clamped at Jan/Dec, collapsing warm-zone windows to "Jan - Jan"; months now wrap the year, and fall-planted garlic shifts earlier in cold zones instead of later

Portfolio & UX polish

- README rewritten as a proper landing page: live link, feature tour with six screenshots (moved to `docs/screenshots/`), architecture notes
- "Try Denver – 80205" one-click demo link on the hero
- Animated hero sprout: grows, unfurls, blooms, then sways (CSS only, reduced-motion safe)
- Bed plans persist across refresh, and any plan can be shared as a URL that reopens the exact bed
- Category + water-wise filter chips on results
- "Why they clash" one-liners on every foe pair; classic-pairing notes on friends
- Zone-typical frost dates on the planting calendar
- Printable bed plan with a print-only masthead and shopping list
- Breadcrumb back to "Zone N plants" from any plant page

- **Fixed:** opening a plant from My Garden dropped the saved zone and nagged for a ZIP the app already knew
- **Fixed:** the bed's "cramped" verdict band was geometrically unreachable; bands recalibrated to real packing densities
- **Fixed:** four smaller items: cross-tab storage clears now sync, bed size inputs no longer fight multi-digit typing, plant lookup is O(1), and El Paso's ZIP prefix maps to its real zone

SEO & platform

- Results pages server-render the zone and full plant grid (crawlers previously saw an empty skeleton on the app's most valuable route)
- All 35 plant pages prerender as static HTML at build time
- Sitemap (37 URLs), robots.txt, Open Graph / Twitter cards with a branded card image, and Article JSON-LD on every plant page
- Malformed ZIP URLs return real 404s instead of indexable soft-404 pages
- Branded seedling favicon and iOS icon; create-next-app template assets removed

Bed Designer showpiece

- Illustrated raised bed: wooden plank frame, speckled soil, dibber-line grid; the soil area stays exactly to scale
- Plants sprout in with a staggered pop and glide to new spots when the layout reflows
- Hover or tap any plant: green threads draw to its friends, rust dashes to its foes, and an inspector card shows footprint, harvest window, and relationships
- Season scrubber: drag from day 0 to harvest and watch every circle grow at its own real rate, with ghost rings for full-grown footprints and golden rings when a plant is ready to pick

Review & hardening

The review's six core correctness findings, all closed the same day:

FINDING	WHY IT MATTERED	STATUS
Zones 12-13 guaranteed an empty result	Every Hawaii, Puerto Rico, and Guam visitor saw a broken app	FIXED
Zone lookup always waited on the API	Up to 1.2s staring at a skeleton for an answer the app already had	FIXED
Water-wise plant data never shipped	A whole feature's content was silently absent; its icons and planting archetypes sat unused	FIXED
My Garden dropped the saved zone	Detail pages nagged for a ZIP the app already knew; reads as broken in a demo	FIXED
Calendar clamped instead of wrapping the year	Zone-10 windows showed "Jan - Jan"; cold-zone garlic shifted the wrong direction agronomically	FIXED
"Cramped" verdict was mathematically unreachable	Beds jumped straight from snug to overcrowded	FIXED

One judgment call surfaced after shipping: the water-wise plants had been removed from the app on purpose in June. The restored version is edibles-only (no ornamental xeriscape flow) and was kept after review. The archived xeriscape project remains untouched for future use.

Deliberately not built (on the roadmap)

ITEM	PRIORITY
Connect the Vercel project to the GitHub repo so pushes auto-deploy (today's deploy was manual <code>vercel --prod</code>)	Medium
Submit the new sitemap in Google Search Console	Medium
Drag-and-drop bed placement with live collision and foe feedback (the deferred showpiece candidate)	Medium
Sun/shade smarts: north arrow + tall-plant shading warnings from mature-size data	Low
Refresh README screenshots to show the new bed visuals; force full-grown view when printing mid-scrub	Low

Paper trail

- `fix/review-bugs` → `seo/portfolio-pass` → `feat/portfolio-polish` → `chore/minor-cleanups` → `feat/bed-showpiece` – the five stacked branches, kept locally, one commit per numbered finding
- `README.md` + `docs/screenshots/` – the new repo landing page and its six committed screenshots
- `docs/reports/2026-07-07-build-report.html` – this report's reskinnable source